

British Period Study: Liberals, Conservatives and the Rise of Labour 1846–1902

Key Topics	Content Learners should have studied the following:
Whigs to Liberals	The repeal of the Corn Laws and its impact on the Whigs, Peelites and Conservatives; the roles and influence of Palmerston, Gladstone and the Radicals in the emergence of the Liberal party; the reasons for the emergence of the Liberal party; the impact of foreign affairs on Britain and in the emergence of the Liberal party including 1848, Don Pacifico, the Crimean War, the Italian Wars of Unification.
Gladstonian Liberalism	The ideas and policies of Gladstonian Liberalism: support for free trade <i>laissez faire</i> and administrative competence; attitudes to Ireland and foreign policy; appeal to different social groups; the 'People's William'; domestic reforms (including Ireland); the reasons for and impact of reforms; the roles of Gladstone and his colleagues; reasons for defeat in 1874.
Disraelian Conservatism	The ideas and policies of Disraelian Conservatism; the effects of the defeat of Peel on the Conservative party; the leadership of Derby; mistrust and political qualities of Disraeli; his support for constitutional reform; the aims and importance of the 1867 Reform Act and reasons for defeat in 1868; One Nation Conservatism: the creation of Tory democracy; support for the monarchy, the Church of England and the aristocracy; belief in security at home; attitudes to Empire and British Interests abroad; domestic reforms and foreign and imperial policies of the 1874–1880 ministry, including their impact; the roles of Disraeli and his colleagues; reasons for defeat in 1880.
Late Victorian politics: Gladstone and Salisbury until 1902	Gladstone's three ministries of 1880–1885, February–July 1886 and 1892–1895; domestic, imperial and foreign policy; Ireland and the failure of Home Rule (including the Gladstone-Chamberlain split of 1886); Gladstone's impact on late Victorian politics; Salisbury's ministries of 1885–1892 and 1895–1902; domestic, imperial and foreign policy; organisational changes within the party, including the Primrose League (1883); Liberal Unionism; Social Reform (education, housing and land); Policy towards Ireland; the Boer War.

Enquiry Topic: England and a New Century c.1900–1918	
Key Topics	Content Learners should have studied the following:
Political issues c.1900–1914	England in 1900; The Conservative government under Balfour 1902–1905; reasons for the Liberal landslide; the origins and development of the Labour Party and the Trade Unions from 1893 to 1914; constitutional crisis, causes, course and results; the issue of women’s suffrage 1906–1914; problems in Ireland 1910–1914; Trade Unions and problems of industrial unrest.
Social issues 1900–1918	The development of ideas of new liberalism, including the role of Lloyd George and Churchill; the debate over poverty (Booth, Rowntree and Galt) and the debate over national efficiency; education and young people: the acts of 1902, 1906 and 1918, school measures, the Children’s Charter; Old Age pensions; National Insurance; measures to protect workers.
Britain at war 1914–1918	Attitudes to war; the impact of war on the Home Front; political developments during the war: the coalition of 1915, the creation of the Lloyd George Coalition; the splits in the Liberal Party and their importance; the development of the Labour Party and its Constitution of 1918; the role of women in the war, and the extension of the franchise in 1918.